

Philipp Hilbert. *AI product leader for agentic data platforms.*

Positioning, Thirteen years shipping B2B products in regulated industries, now building with AI agents daily.

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§ WHY MATILLION

Maia is not a chatbot bolted onto a data pipeline, it is an agent that owns data engineering work end to end, which is a harder and more interesting product problem than most AI companies are tackling. The challenge of setting a quality bar for agentic behaviour, building the evals, and knowing when to hold the line is exactly the kind of depth I want to work at. The fact that Cisco, DocuSign, and Slack are already running on it means the product is past the demo stage and into the hard part: scaling trust. *That is the stage where rigorous discovery and honest evaluation matter most.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, continuous coding assist
- **Cursor**, context-heavy editing sessions
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research and synthesis
- **Framer**, design-heavy work
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder decks
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kotlin (Spring Boot), REST APIs, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, GitOps rollout and rollback, CI/CD pipelines, ETL pipelines, OpenShift, Red Hat infrastructure, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built and run solo.

- Matches firms with workers directly, removing the headhunter from the hire with an anonymity-until-payment model.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, with LLM agents running funnel stages autonomously.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one operator runs the full day-to-day.
 - Proves end-to-end agentic workflow design in a live commercial product, the same problem Maia solves for data teams.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MATILLION

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow data engineers using Maia, map the real friction points in their workflow, and read every eval and metric already in place so I know what the team considers "good" before forming my own view.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the eval baseline.

Identify one agentic behaviour where the quality bar is fuzzy, draft a concrete eval for it with Engineering, and run it against current output to get a number we can argue about.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close loops.

Pick the highest-signal improvement surfaced in weeks one and two, drive it through to production, and put the eval result in the next stakeholder update.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Matillion team,

Data engineering teams are bottlenecked, and the answer is an agent that can own the work, not just assist with it. That distinction matters: most AI tools in the data space are still in co-pilot mode, and the product challenge of getting to genuine autonomy, where a team actually trusts the output, is one I have been thinking about seriously.

My thirteen years of product ownership spans regulated and data-heavy environments: a national labour-market analytics platform at Bundesagentur für Arbeit, an AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme at Rohde & Schwarz, and a B2B SaaS platform for insurers at EMIL Group. In each case the hard work was not writing requirements, it was instrumenting workflows to find what users actually did versus what they said, then holding the quality bar under delivery pressure. At Rohde & Schwarz I ran two competing pipeline workflows in parallel and found the UI-led one recorded zero clicks. That kind of instrumented discovery is how I would approach Maia's eval and prioritisation work.

I use agentic workflows in my own product work every day, Claude Code, n8n orchestration, LLM agents across a live marketplace product I built solo. I am familiar with the operational tradeoffs in context management, tool use, and evaluation loops from building them, not just reading about them. When your posting mentions reasoning with Engineering about models, MCP, and orchestration, those are conversations I can contribute to, not just observe.

The data domain knowledge is a asset I can bring: ETL pipeline ownership with Dagster and dbt at Bundesagentur für Arbeit, container migration, and data platform product work across engineering and data science teams. The specific warehousing layer, Snowflake, Databricks, is territory I have not owned directly, but the architecture patterns and the user problems in data integration are familiar ground.

I would welcome the chance to talk about what the current quality gaps in Maia look like and how the team is measuring them.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, including AI and data platform work at Rohde & Schwarz and Bundesagentur für Arbeit, B2B SaaS delivery at EMIL Group, and agentic workflow products built independently. I run continuous discovery, turn strategy, user needs, and technical constraints into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe).

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design. Instrumented two competing workflows; the UI-led one recorded zero clicks.
- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams and making the platform hotfix-capable.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, freeing several QA hours every week, and migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers.
- Carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period while the team ran autonomous environment control.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL &
CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute.

- Owned data structures and identity management for the DIM and DESH programmes.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.
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§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025-PRESENT

Construction staffing, two-sided B2B marketplace.

- Built zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the day-to-day.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016-12/2021

IT security. Integrated hardware and software for quantum-secure encryption.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes after enterprise buyers refused longer installations. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013-11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments.

- Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.
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§ SKILLS

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Lovable.

Analytics and Data: ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), PostgreSQL, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, prototyping, A/B testing, user research and interviews, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, OpenShift.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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